

JOHN LEE

Chicago, IL (open to relocation)

310-846-7030

Portfolio: johnkleejr.com

LinkedIn: [in/john-lee-779329401](https://in.linkedin.com/in/john-lee-779329401)

GitHub: github.com/jkleejr

Email: johnkleejr@gmail.com

SUMMARY

Built four AI projects solo this year, including an iOS app on the App Store, handling the UI/UX, prototyping, and code from first idea to working product. Designs around real constraints (platform limitations, LLM accuracy, latency, and API costs) and balances them with user and business goals.

SKILLS

UI/UX Design: Interaction Design, AI/LLM UX, Prototyping, User Flows, Information Architecture, Usability Testing, Figma

iOS & Mobile: Swift, SwiftUI, Xcode, ActivityKit (Dynamic Island), React Native, Expo

Front-end: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, HTML, CSS

AI: Claude API, Gemini API, Prompt Design & Structured Outputs, AI-Assisted Development (Claude Code, Antigravity)

Other: Sound Design, Audio Engineering, Music Production (Ableton, Logic Pro)

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego
La Jolla, CA · 2018 – 2023

**Bachelor of Science (B.S.),
Cognitive Science**

Relevant Courses: Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Interaction Design, Usability and Information Architecture, Innovation and Technology Strategy

Product Designer & Design Engineer

Designing and building AI-native iOS and web products end to end.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Loot Check — iOS App, Live on the App Store

Jun 2026 – Sep 2026

- Designed and shipped a free app that identifies, prices, and suggests where to sell photographed items, reaching 100+ organic downloads and 870 scans in two months with no marketing
- Designed for LLM uncertainty with confidence labels, optional keyword hints, and retry flows so users know when to trust a price estimate
- Routed requests through a Vercel serverless function to keep API keys off-device, and capped usage with Upstash Redis (100 scans per device, 1,000 per day)
- Limited web searches to original items, avoiding a 3–4x cost and 4x latency increase (Claude Sonnet 4.6, ~\$0.013 per scan)

Screen Translator — iOS Prototype

Sep 2026

- Built an app that translates on-screen Korean to English in real time through the Dynamic Island, since iOS does not let apps draw over other apps (Swift, ReplayKit, Apple Vision OCR, ActivityKit)
- Designed around the Dynamic Island's system-controlled states and added a crop box so users choose which part of the screen to translate
- Benchmarked Claude Opus 5 against DeepL (2.07s vs. 0.73s median latency, ~5x the cost); used DeepL for sentences, Opus 5 for words

Paper Reader — iOS Prototype

Jul 2026 – Aug 2026

- Built a Swift app that reads research PDFs aloud, skipping citations, using Gemini 3.1 Flash for text cleanup and text-to-speech
- Cut wait time to ~20 seconds by generating audio in 50-second groups, with later groups loading in the background
- Highlighted the spoken sentence without audio timestamps by estimating timing from character count

Buy Side Briefings — Live Website

May 2026 – Present

- Designed and built an automated system that publishes morning and evening market reports, replacing manual research across news, SEC filings, and social media
- Wrote the research agent's instructions, which direct parallel web queries and define the JSON schema the site renders
- Designed an interactive candlestick chart, an AM/PM toggle that reshapes each report, and an earnings timeline

EXPERIENCE

Web Designer & Developer @ Time with Tree

Sejong, South Korea · Freelance · May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Designed and built a website and online store for a birch tree nursery: catalog, cart, bank-transfer checkout, order lookup, and order emails